

1 Development of a nation: Unification of Germany, 1848-71

	• The importance of the 1848 revolutions • Economic factors favouring unification • Bismarck's aims and methods • Wars against Denmark and Austria • Franco-Prussian War
• The key events of 1848-9 including the Frankfurt Assembly, Prussian support for a union of Germany, the Erfurt Union, the opposition of Austria and the refusal of Frederick William of Prussia to become emperor. Effects on German nationalism and liberalism. • The importance of the industrial development of Prussia and a national railway system. The development of the Zollverein – Prussian leadership, wider membership and exclusion of Austria. • The Prussian Budget Crisis 1861. Bismarck becomes Minister-President. Bismarck's determination to unite Germany under Prussian leadership and exclude Austria. Use of diplomacy to isolate rivals and war 'blood and iron'. • Use of Schleswig-Holstein to provoke Denmark. Defeat of Denmark and Convention of Gastein. Diplomacy to isolate and provoke Austria. Sadowa (Koniggratz) and reasons for Prussian victory. Treaty of Prague and establishment of North German Confederation. • Diplomacy to isolate France. The Ems Telegram. Support of southern states. Key events of the Franco-Prussian War. The battles of Sedan and Metz and the siege of Paris. Reasons for the Prussian victory. Treaty of Frankfurt and the Proclamation of the German Empire.	